

THE LONG NOON

a weird-western deck builder for 3-5 · about 40 minutes · PROTOTYPE v1

THE SHAPE OF IT

You are a posse holding a frontier town together while something underneath it wakes up. You build decks. You fight ordinary trouble. Then you start buying Signs, because Signs are better than anything honest on the table, and Signs are how the thing gets in.

One of you is Marked. They do not sabotage. They encourage.

SETUP

- Deal one Role card to each player, face down. One Marked, the rest Faithful. Look, then hide.
- Each player takes an identical 8-card starting deck. Shuffle. Draw 5.
- Shuffle the 20 Provisions. Deal 4 face up. This deck is NEVER reshuffled.
- Lay out all 12 Signs face up in a row. They are always available.
- Shuffle the 12 Trouble cards (9 Trouble + 3 Omens). Set the 10 Mythos cards aside, face up, readable.
- Set the Whisper track to 0. Set Doom to 0. The Street has 3 empty slots.
- Set the Fevered cards and the Old One board aside where everyone can see them.

A ROUND

1. DAWN — Reveal 1 Trouble card into the leftmost empty slot of the Street. If the Street is full, the oldest card resolves its Menace immediately and is discarded.
2. THE DAY — In turn order, each player takes 3 actions. An action is: play a card, buy a card, or clear damage onto a Threat. Cards not played may be spent for their GRIT value to pay for buys. Discard your hand at the end of your turn and draw 5.
3. DUSK — Every unresolved Threat deals its Menace. Omens add Whispers. Check the Whisper track.

DAMAGE, AND WHY YOU SHOULD BE FRIGHTENED

There is no health track. When you take damage, trash that many cards from your deck — Provisions and Kit before Signs, always. You choose which within that. Trashed cards go to your boneyard, face up.

So a wounded player gets more corrupt, not just weaker. Signs cannot be trashed by damage, by choice, or by any card that says 'trash'. Burying a Sign voluntarily costs you a permanent Scar.

Buying is the only healing in the game. When the Provision deck runs dry, healing stops existing.

THE TURNING

When the Whisper track reaches 12, the game changes in the middle of the round. Finish the current player's turn, then:

- The Marked player reveals. If the Marked player is dead, the first Revenant reveals instead.
- THE VESSEL is whichever LIVING player holds the most Signs — Marked or not. Ties go to the Marked player, then to the player with the most Scars. That player takes the Old One board.
- Every Sign in every deck, hand, and discard pile is swapped for its FEVERED card. Permanently.
- Every Trouble card still in the Street flips to its reverse. Cards with no reverse stay as they are.
- The Trouble deck is removed from the game. The Mythos deck replaces it. Two Mythos cards enter per round.
- Doom begins at 3. If the Marked player achieved their secret aim, it begins at 6.
- Nothing in Act II pays a Bounty. Ever.

FALLING, AND THE REVENANT

You fall when your deck and discard are both empty at the moment you would draw. You do not leave. Flip your player board.

Trash every remaining Provision and Kit from your deck. Keep every Sign, Fevered side up. This is now your whole deck and it will never grow. Take 3 Grave tokens. You get 2 actions per turn instead of 3, and you may not buy cards, ever.

REVENANT ACTIONS — Play a Fevered card (you choose all targets). WHISPER: discard a card, +1 Whisper.

BECKON: name a living player; if they buy a Sign this turn, they gain 1 Grit. RISE: spend a Grave token to return from being buried.

When your deck runs out, shuffle your discard MINUS one card, trashed permanently. You shrink every cycle.

BURYING A REVENANT — Two living players each spend an action. The Revenant is out until they spend a Grave token to Rise. One of the burying players takes a Scar. At 0 Grave tokens the Revenant is gone for good — and the Whisper track gains 3.

HUSK — If you fall before the end of round 3, you are a Husk instead: 1 action, no Beckon, 1 Grave token. At the Turning you wake fully with 3 Grave tokens. Dying early is worse, not better.

A Revenant wins if and only if the Old One wins. They may speak freely. They may lie or not.

WINNING

THE OLD ONE WINS if Doom reaches 20, or if every living player has fallen.

THE POSSE WINS by burying the Vessel: deal 12 total damage to the Vessel across any number of turns, while no Omen sits in the Street. Damage to the Vessel resets to 0 if an Omen enters.

Doom rises: +1 per Omen at Dusk, +1 per unresolved Mythos Threat at Dusk, +2 whenever the Old One spends an action to Whisper.

THE OLD ONE

Taken by the Vessel at the Turning. You keep your own deck — all Signs, all Fevered, and now you aim them again. You take 3 actions on your turn, after all living players.

- **PLAY** — play a Fevered card from your hand, targets of your choosing.
- **CALL** — name a living player. They reveal the top card of their deck. If it is a Sign, it resolves Fevered against them and is discarded. Everything they bought is yours now.
- **SUMMON** — put a Mythos card from the deck into an empty slot in the Street.
- **WHISPER** — +2 Doom.

You cannot buy. Your deck shrinks by one card each time it recycles, exactly as a Revenant's does. You are strongest the moment you wake.

WHISPER TRACK

0

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

11

12

12 = THE TURNING

DOOM TRACK

0

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

11

12

13

14

15

16

17

18

19

20

THE STREET

SLOT 1

SLOT 2

SLOT 3

Lay each Threat card above its slot. Slot 1 fills first; slot 1 resolves first when the Street overflows.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR IN TESTING

- Does anyone ever buy zero Signs, or only Signs? Both answers should be no. If not, move Sign costs.
- Does the Turning land around the 60% mark? If it fires before round 5, raise the threshold to 14.
- Is burying a Revenant ever worth two actions and a Scar? If nobody ever does it, drop it to one action.
- Does the Fevered flip feel interesting or just annoying? Watch faces at the moment of the swap.
- Play your FIRST session with no Marked player, and do not tell anyone. If the deck builder is not tense on its own, the traitor is covering for a weak core.

POSSE

3 actions per turn · draw 5 · buying is healing

ACTIONS: play a card / buy a card / deal damage
Unplayed cards may be spent for GRIT.
Damage trashes cards. Kit and Provisions first. Signs never.

SCARS



BONEYARD

trashed cards, face up, where everyone can see them

REVENANT

2 actions per turn · never buy · you win only if the Old One wins

ACTIONS: play a Fevered card / WHISPER (+1) / BECKON / RISE
Deck loses one card permanently on every recycle.
Buried by two living players; Rise costs a Grave token.

SCARS



GRAVE TOKENS



SADDLEBAG

KIT

GRIT 1

SADDLEBAG

KIT

GRIT 1

SADDLEBAG

KIT

GRIT 1

SIX-GUN

KIT

Deal 1 damage to a Threat.

GRIT 1

SIX-GUN

KIT

Deal 1 damage to a Threat.

GRIT 1

CANTEEN

KIT

Draw 1.

GRIT 1

GRUBSTAKE

KIT

GRIT 2

BAD NERVE

KIT

Draw 2, then discard 1.

GRIT 0

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ONCE PER PLAYER**

STARTING DECK

Eight identical cards. Every player begins the same. Character asymmetry is a v2 problem.

WINCHESTER

KIT · COST 3

Deal 2 damage to a Threat.

GRIT 1

WINCHESTER

KIT · COST 3

Deal 2 damage to a Threat.

GRIT 1

WINCHESTER

KIT · COST 3

Deal 2 damage to a Threat.

GRIT 1

SCATTERGUN

KIT · COST 4

Deal 3 damage to a Threat.

GRIT 1

SCATTERGUN

KIT · COST 4

Deal 3 damage to a Threat.

GRIT 1

HARD TACK

KIT · COST 2

GRIT 2

HARD TACK

KIT · COST 2

GRIT 2

HARD TACK

KIT · COST 2

GRIT 2

DOC MIRELES' BAG

KIT · COST 4

Return a trashed Provision from the boneyard to your discard pile.

GRIT 1

DOC MIRELES' BAG

KIT · COST 4

Return a trashed Provision from the boneyard to your discard pile.

GRIT 1

THE SHERIFF'S STAR

KIT · COST 5

+1 action this turn.

GRIT 2

LANTERN OIL

DEED · COST 2

Trash this. Reduce one Threat's Clear value by 2 permanently.

GRIT 1

LANTERN OIL

DEED · COST 2

Trash this. Reduce one Threat's Clear value by 2 permanently.

GRIT 1

A BOTTLE OF THE GOOD STUFF

DEED · COST 2

Trash this. Draw 2.

GRIT 1

A BOTTLE OF THE GOOD STUFF

DEED · COST 2

Trash this. Draw 2.

GRIT 1

GOOD ROPE

KIT · COST 3

Draw 1.

GRIT 2

GOOD ROPE

KIT · COST 3

Draw 1.

GRIT 2

FRESH HORSES

KIT · COST 3

+1 action this turn.

GRIT 1

FRESH HORSES

KIT · COST 3

+1 action this turn.

GRIT 1

BANK DRAFT

KIT · COST 4

GRIT 3

THE COLT THAT DOESN'T MISS

SIGN · COST 4

Destroy any one Threat in the Street.

GRIT 2 · 3 WHISPERS

PARSON GRIMM'S BLESSING

SIGN · COST 3

Return a trashed card from any player's boneyard to their discard pile.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

DYNAMITE FROM THE OLD SHAFT

SIGN · COST 3

Destroy a Threat with Clear 3 or less.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

A DEBT COMES DUE

SIGN · COST 2

Draw 3.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

NIGHT WATCH

SIGN · COST 3

Once per round, cancel one Threat's Menace.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

LAST WORDS

SIGN · COST 4

When your deck would empty, keep 2 cards instead of falling.

GRIT 2 · 3 WHISPERS

THE HYMN WITH NO AUTHOR

SIGN · COST 3

+2 actions this turn.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

PROSPECTOR'S CERTAINTY

SIGN · COST 2

+3 Grit this turn.

GRIT 2 · 1 WHISPER

STAKE THE CLAIM

SIGN · COST 2

Take a face-up Provision for free.

GRIT 2 · 1 WHISPER

WHAT THE COYOTE TOLD ME

SIGN · COST 2

Look at the top 3 cards of the Threat deck. Reorder them.

GRIT 2 · 1 WHISPER

SALT LINE AT THE DOOR

SIGN · COST 3

Prevent 2 damage to any player.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

THE WIDOW'S INSTRUCTION

SIGN · COST 3

Trash a card from your hand.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

IT CHOOSES

FEVERED

Destroy the Threat in the leftmost slot. If there is none, deal 3 damage to the player on your left.

GRIT 2 · 3 WHISPERS

THE PARSON KNOWS BETTER

FEVERED

Return a trashed card to the discard pile of the player holding the most Signs.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

THE SHAFT REMEMBERS

FEVERED

Destroy a Threat with Clear 3 or less. Every player trashes one card.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

THE LEDGER READS ITSELF

FEVERED

Draw 3, then discard your hand. Cannot be spent for Grit.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

SOMETHING ELSE IS WATCHING

FEVERED

Cancel the FIRST Menace each round, whoever it targets. You do not choose.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

HE DIDN'T STAY DOWN

FEVERED

When ANY player would fall, they keep 2 cards. You take a Scar.

GRIT 2 · 3 WHISPERS

YOU KNOW ALL THE VERSES

FEVERED

+2 actions this turn. Must be played the turn it is drawn.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

HE NEVER STOPPED DIGGING

FEVERED

+3 Grit. You must buy a Sign this turn if you can afford one.

GRIT 2 · 1 WHISPER

THE CLAIM STAKES YOU

FEVERED

The player on your left takes it instead. Add 1 Whisper.

GRIT 2 · 1 WHISPER

THE COYOTE ASKS AFTER YOU

FEVERED

Look at the top 3. The Old One looks at your hand and may name one card you cannot play next turn.

GRIT 2 · 1 WHISPER

THE LINE HAS BEEN CROSSED

FEVERED

Prevent 2 damage. Add 1 Whisper each time this triggers.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

SHE HAS OTHER INSTRUCTIONS

FEVERED

Trash a card from your hand. If it was a Provision, gain a Sign of cost 2 or less.

GRIT 2 · 2 WHISPERS

CLAIM JUMPERS

TROUBLE

CLEAR 3 · MENACE 1

BOUNTY: Take a face-up Provision for free.

ACT I · HAS A REVERSE

RUSTLERS AT THE DRAW

TROUBLE

CLEAR 2 · MENACE 1

BOUNTY: +2 Grit on your next turn.

ACT I · HAS A REVERSE

CATTLE BARON'S MEN

TROUBLE

CLEAR 4 · MENACE 2

BOUNTY: Take any two face-up Provisions for free.

ACT I · HAS A REVERSE

PRAIRIE FIRE

TROUBLE

CLEAR 3 · MENACE 2

BOUNTY: Trash a card from your hand, then +3 Grit.

ACT I · HAS A REVERSE

THE CARDSHARP

TROUBLE

CLEAR 2 · MENACE 0

BOUNTY: Draw 2.

ACT I

STAGECOACH ROBBERY

TROUBLE

CLEAR 3 · MENACE 1

BOUNTY: +3 Grit on your next turn.

ACT I

THE HANGING TREE DISPUTE

TROUBLE

CLEAR 2 · MENACE 1

BOUNTY: Trash a card from your hand.

ACT I

BRAWL AT THE SILVER BIT

TROUBLE

CLEAR 2 · MENACE 1

BOUNTY: Draw 1. All players +1 Grit next turn.

ACT I

HORSE THIEVES

TROUBLE

CLEAR 3 · MENACE 1

BOUNTY: Take a face-up Provision for free.

ACT I

DEAD CATTLE, NO WOUNDS

OMEN

Cannot be cleared. Occupies a slot. +1
Whisper at end of each round.

ACT I

THE WELL TASTES LIKE PENNIES

OMEN

Cannot be cleared. Occupies a slot. +1
Whisper at end of each round.

ACT I

THE PREACHER WON'T COME OUT

OMEN

Cannot be cleared. Occupies a slot. +1
Whisper at end of each round.

ACT I

THEY WERE NEVER MINERS

TURNED

Clear 5 / Menace 2. Menace targets the player with the fewest cards in deck.

ACT II

THEY BROUGHT THE HERD BACK

TURNED

Clear 5 / Menace 2. Cannot be cleared while any Omen is in the Street.

ACT II

THE BARON KEPT HIS PROMISE

TURNED

Clear 6 / Menace 3. When cleared, add 2 Whispers.

ACT II

IT BURNS THE WRONG COLOUR

TURNED

Clear 4 / Menace 2. Menace hits every player.

ACT II

THE THING IN THE WELL

MYTHOS

CLEAR 5 · MENACE 2

If unresolved at end of round: +1 Doom.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

CHOIR OF THE DRY GRASS

MYTHOS

CLEAR - · MENACE 0

Cannot be damaged. Toll: a player must trash a Sign and take a Scar to remove it.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

YOUR OWN FACE, WAITING

MYTHOS

CLEAR 4 · MENACE 3

Menace targets the living player holding the most Signs.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

NOTHING COMES

MYTHOS

CLEAR - · MENACE 0

Nothing happens this round. No Menace resolves. Discard at end of round.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

SOMETHING WEARING THE SHERIFF

MYTHOS

CLEAR 5 · MENACE 2

Toll: while in the Street, players may not buy Provisions.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

THE SKY HAS A SEAM IN IT

MYTHOS

CLEAR 6 · MENACE 1

If unresolved at end of round: +2 Doom.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

THE TOWN BENEATH THE TOWN

MYTHOS

CLEAR 4 · MENACE 2

Toll: when cleared, the clearing player takes a Scar.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

ALL THE DOORS OPEN INWARD

MYTHOS

CLEAR 3 · MENACE 2

Toll: players may not spend cards for Grit this round.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

GRANDMOTHER COYOTE'S DEBT

MYTHOS

CLEAR 4 · MENACE 1

Toll: the Old One may Call once for free each round this is in play.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

THE LONG NOON

MYTHOS

CLEAR 7 · MENACE 3

When this enters the Street, +3 Doom.
Menace hits every living player.

ACT II · NO BOUNTY

FAITHFUL

ROLE

You are what you appear to be.

You win with the posse: bury the Vessel
before Doom reaches 20.

KEEP HIDDEN

FAITHFUL

ROLE

You are what you appear to be.

You win with the posse: bury the Vessel
before Doom reaches 20.

KEEP HIDDEN

FAITHFUL

ROLE

You are what you appear to be.

You win with the posse: bury the Vessel
before Doom reaches 20.

KEEP HIDDEN

THE MARKED

ROLE

You are the door.

You win only if the Old One wins.

You do NOT sabotage. You encourage.

SECRET AIM: at the Turning, two other
players must each hold 3 or more
Signs. If they do, you begin the Old
One's turn with +3 Doom.

KEEP HIDDEN